PIA3142 Global Social Movements — Haidt, *The Righteous Mind* (Vintage 2012), Chs. 7 & 9

1. The Reading: Scope and Placement

Keywords: Ch. 7 (pp. 143–171), Ch. 9 (pp. 206–238), Ch. 8 excluded, third principle

- Jonathan Haidt (2012), *The Righteous Mind: Why Good People Are Divided by Politics and Religion*. Assigned: Ch. 7, "The Moral Foundations of Politics" (pp. 143–171), and Ch. 9, "Why Are We So Groupish?" (pp. 206–238); Ch. 8 is excluded.
- Ch. 7 (Part II) = five foundations + left–right asymmetry; Ch. 9 (opens Part III) = group selection + the third principle. Ch. 9's "six foundations" and "Durkheimian societies" references point to Ch. 8.
- → Ch. 7 says what morality contains; Ch. 9 why it binds us to groups.

2. Ch. 7 — Against Homo economicus: Figure 7.1 "What's Your Price?"

Keywords: selfishness or stupidity, economic man, five pairs, intuitive flash

- Social scientists held that altruism hides "either selfishness or stupidity" (Haidt 2012, Ch7 p. 143), resting on Homo economicus, "economic man," who chooses like a supermarket shopper comparing jars of applesauce.
- Figure 7.1 (Ch7 p. 144): ten questions, five pairs; column B = "an intuitive flash from each foundation, like putting a grain of salt or sugar on your tongue": Care (child hurt), Fairness (undeserved profit), Loyalty (criticizing your nation), Authority (disrespecting your father), Sanctity (degrading act).
- *Example:* economic man prices a needle in his own arm, not the nine costless actions.
- → If any column-B action felt worse, you are "a human being, not an economist's fantasy" — you have "a working set of moral foundations."

3. Ch. 7 — Defining Innateness: "Organized in Advance of Experience"

Keywords: hardwired vs prewired, first draft, Marcus, two jobs of MFT

- Old standard: innate = hardwired, unchangeable, universal; almost nothing passed, and the "tribe somewhere without it" test silenced complex claims. Now a trait can be innate without being hardwired or universal.
- Gary Marcus: the newborn brain is "prewired — flexible and subject to change — rather than hardwired, fixed, and immutable" — a first draft written by the genes; no chapter finished, none blank.

- Innateness: "Nature provides a first draft, which experience then revises.... 'organized in advance of experience.'" (Ch7 p. 145)
- Moral Foundations Theory's two jobs: specify the first draft (five foundations); explain how experience revises it into cultural and political moralities.

4. Ch. 7 — Foundation 1: Care/harm

Keywords: vulnerable children, fewer bets bigger investment, attachment, expandable triggers, politics

4.1 Origin and the Innate Module — the mothering chapter

Keywords: mammal suckling, distress sensitivity, attachment theory

- Reptiles abandon eggs; mammal suckling made motherhood costly — fewer bets, bigger investment; big-brained humans are extreme (child born a year before walking, unraisable alone). Challenge: keep the vulnerable child safe.
- Mothers sensitive to distress and neediness outbred less sensitive sisters → the Care module + attachment theory (protection plus freedom to explore).

4.2 Triggers and the Political Application — cuteness and campaigns

Keywords: Max photo, cuteness, Save Darfur, wounded warrior, tear ducts

- Current triggers of a module often far outnumber original triggers — Max photo: cuteness primes care; any child, even stuffed monkeys (Gogo), triggers Care.
- Politics: parties must activate a foundation to win votes, money, time. *Example:* "Save Darfur" (liberal universalist Care) vs "wounded warrior" (conservative Care + Loyalty).
- → Darwin explains the tear ducts, not each tear.

5. Ch. 7 — Foundation 2: Fairness/cheating

Keywords: reciprocity, tit for tat, cheaters, equality vs proportionality, Occupy vs Tea Party

5.1 Trivers and Reciprocal Altruism (1971) — selective generosity

Keywords: selfish genes, selective generosity, kin vs non-kin, reputation

- A coworker covers your work five days for your Caribbean vacation: an unpayable favour, not a free bag of groceries.
- Robert Trivers (1971), reciprocal altruism: selfish genes build generous creatures if generosity is selective; kin altruism is no puzzle, non-kin the long-running puzzle. Evolves with memory of interactions, limiting niceness to likely reciprocators — tit for tat.

5.2 Triggers and the Two Kinds of Fairness — equality vs proportionality

Keywords: without getting suckered, original vs current triggers, equality vs proportionality

- "Tit for tat" beat "help anyone" (invites exploitation) and "take but don't give"; triggers: liking at trustworthiness, anger/contempt/disgust at cheating. *Example:* Occupy Wall Street (exploiters) vs the Tea Party ("socialists" taking from hardworking Americans).
- → Left fairness = equality; right = proportionality — reward by contribution (exam-friendly).

6. Ch. 7 — Foundation 3: Loyalty/betrayal

Keywords: tribalism, Robbers Cave, team players, traitors, universalism vs nationalism

6.1 Sherif's Robbers Cave Experiment (1954) — rivals made, not born

Keywords: Muzafar Sherif, Rattlers and Eagles, territory, weeklong tournament

- Muzafar Sherif (1954): twenty-two sets of working-class parents' twelve-year-old boys, three weeks at camp, two groups of eleven arriving on consecutive days. Alone for five days, each still marked territory and formed norms, songs, identities (Rattlers never cry; Eagles never curse), a leader — rehearsing rivalry.
- Day 6: the Rattlers heard the Eagles had the baseball field and begged to challenge them; the tournament was "entered into with more zest and also with more efficiency"; raids, vandalized bunks, socks filled with rocks.

6.2 Triggers, Traitors, and Politics — dishonour and suspicion

Keywords: male mind, warfare, apostates, Dante, Coulter

- The male mind appears innately tribal: boys enjoy intergroup conflict including war; girls' loyalty objects are more often two-person; chimps raid and kill too. "Descendants of successful tribalists."
- Traitors are hated more than enemies: *Example:* the Koran commands killing apostates, not Jews; Dante's innermost hell is for treachery. Left universalism struggles with Loyalty (Coulter, *Treason*).

7. Ch. 7 — Foundation 4: Authority/subversion

Keywords: hierarchy, control role, legitimate asymmetries, Fiske, two directions

7.1 Origin: Dominance Hierarchies and the Control Role — the control role

Keywords: vous vs tu, submissive displays, alpha male, Frans de Waal, Hammurabi

- A Jordanian taxi driver would forgo the United States rather than hear "fuck you" from his son; French vous/tu — languages encode hierarchy; discomfort at a salesperson's first name = Authority modules.
- Origin: dominance hierarchies (chickens, dogs, chimps); submissive displays converge — seem small, unthreatening. Authority ≠ power: the alpha plays the "control role." de Waal: "Without agreement on rank and a certain respect for authority there can be no great sensitivity to social rules."
- Hammurabi was called "so that the strong should not harm the weak."

7.2 Fiske, Triggers, and Politics — legitimate asymmetries

Keywords: Alan Fiske, legitimate asymmetries, status tracking, Methodists vs Unitarians

- Alan Fiske's Authority Ranking: subordinates defer and obey, superiors take pastoral responsibility — legitimate asymmetries, not coercive power. (Ch7 p. 160) It converted Haidt from the liberal equation hierarchy = power = exploitation = evil.
- Modules track rank up and down; subversion stings without direct harm. Easier for the right to build on Authority than a left defined against hierarchy ("ain't no Unitarians").

8. Ch. 7 — Foundation 5: Sanctity/degradation

Keywords: Meiwes, harm principle, ethic of divinity, omnivore's dilemma, sacredness, culture wars

8.1 Meiwes vs the Harm Principle — The Divinity Response

Keywords: cannibalism, consent, Mill, stain and pollution, Shweder

- 2001: Armin Meiwes advertised for "a well-built 21-to-30-year-old to be slaughtered and then consumed"; Bernd Brandes, 43, consented on video; Meiwes ate him over ten months — manslaughter, not murder. Condemning it collides with Mill's harm principle: power over a person, against his will, only to prevent harm to others.
- The stain/house thought experiment exposes Shweder's ethic of divinity: a human body treated as meat, "as low as any humans can go." Stain, pollution, purification.

8.2 Origin: Disgust, the Omnivore's Dilemma, and Sacredness — from microbes to the sacred

Keywords: Rozin, neophilia vs neophobia, behavioral immune system, out-groups

- Origin: omnivore's dilemma (Rozin) — explore foods, stay wary (neophilia vs neophobia; liberals later more open). Disgust weighs calories vs microbes; Schaller's behavioral immune system; triggers expand, often to out-groups.
- Sacredness = untouchable bad and good: flags, Mecca, saints as infinite value bind communities; desecration brings swift collective punishment; Mill's principle "inadequate as the basis for a moral community."

8.3 Sanctity in Politics — Culture Wars and the Left

Keywords: sanctity of life and marriage, Memling, Silver Ring Thing, Bentham, Kass

- "Sanctity of life and marriage," body as temple vs machine. *Example:* the Silver Ring Thing chastity movement vs Bentham's hedons. The left has sanctities too (toxins, environment, abortion). Kass's "Wisdom of Repugnance": "Shallow are the souls that have forgotten how to shudder."

9. Ch. 7 — "In Sum": Five Foundations, Left–Right Asymmetry

Keywords: one line each, memorise, left = Care + Fairness, right = all five

- Five foundations (memorise): Care → suffering; Fairness → cheat-punishment; Loyalty → team players, traitors; Authority → rank, subversion; Sanctity → disgust, irrational value binding groups.
- → Left = Care + Fairness; right = all five. True Taste: two receptors vs five — conservative advantage connecting with voters.

10. Ch. 9 — The Opening Puzzle: Selfish, Groupish, Group Selection

Keywords: 9/11 flag, Glaucon, groupishness, two options, banished heresy

10.1 The 9/11 Flag and the Glauconian Portrait — alarm box and Glaucon

Keywords: alarm box, look good vs be good, kin selection, reputation, team players

- 9/11: an urge Haidt was embarrassed to admit — an American flag decal, "an ancient alarm box… 'In case of foreign attack, break glass and push button'"; he gave blood, donated; windshield US + UN flags.
- So far Glaucon: looking good > being good; intuitions first, reasoning second; kin selection + reciprocity + reputation management. But we are also groupish — teams and clubs, shoulder to shoulder, as if designed for teamwork.

10.2 Definitions, the Two Options, and the Plan — balance sheet and thesis

Keywords: selfish vs groupish, individual vs group selection, morality binds and blinds, multilevel

- Selfish mechanisms promote our own interests against our peers. Groupish ones promote our group's interests against other groups. "Sometimes good team players."
- Balance sheet (memorise): (1) within-group — groupish individuals win (Glauconian, appearance not reality); (2) between-group — cohesive groups win (group selection, "banished as a heresy… in the 1970s"). One-liner: individual selection favours free riders; group selection favours cohesion.
- Plan: four "exhibits"; third principle Morality binds and blinds; multilevel selection thesis.

11. Ch. 9 — Darwin's Case and the Free Rider Objection

Keywords: Descent of Man, tribal competition, free rider, multilevel selection, real armies

11.1 The Case, the Objection, and Multilevel Selection — Russian dolls

Keywords: courage and sympathy, coherence, Russian dolls, bravest army, bees vs humans

- Darwin: "courageous, sympathetic and faithful" tribes beat less cohesive ones — "Selfish and contentious people will not cohere."
- Free rider objection: "benevolent parents" rear no more offspring than "selfish and treacherous"; the self-sacrificer "would often leave no offspring to inherit his noble nature."
- Multilevel selection: nested Russian dolls — genes, cells, organisms, hives, societies; the bravest army wins, but within it cowards most likely father children; suicidal sacrifice only where within-group competition ends (bees); humans need training for a suicide bomber.

11.2 Darwin's Steps, Real Armies, and the Decline — praise, blame, 1966

Keywords: praise and blame, sacred duties, coward shot in the back, 1966

- Steps: social instincts → reciprocity → "praise and blame of our fellow-men" → duties as sacred; armies: the coward beaten, abandoned, or shot in the back. Suppress selfishness and group selection gains power.
- Decline: Darwin's account satisfied ~100 years; free-rider solutions never worked out; naive group-benefit claims multiplied; 1966 brought it to a halt.

12. Ch. 9 — "A Fast Herd of Deer?": Williams, Dawkins, Banishment

Keywords: George Williams 1966, design process, fast herd of deer, kin selection, Dawkins, me decade

12.1 Williams and the Fast Herd of Deer — design at each level

Keywords: Panglossian mushiness, lower-level selection, sentinels, between-group selection

- Williams (1966), after "Panglossian mushiness": selection is a design process; adaptation at a level implies selection at that level; "A fast herd of deer is nothing more than a herd of fast deer." Group analysis only for group-protection mechanisms (sentinels, lures).

12.2 The Banishment, the "Me Decade," and the Counter-Argument — the gene's-eye view

Keywords: kin selection, Selfish Gene 1976, man is selfish, misfirings, giraffes of altruism

- Williams: "group-related adaptations do not in fact exist" (selfishness or kin selection); Dawkins's *Selfish Gene* (1976); the "me decade": "man is selfish."
- Counter: misfirings story ("we are born selfish") vs "giraffes of altruism": cooperation is ubiquitous in groups that know each other — "Forty-five Unrelated College Students Work Together… for No Pay" is no headline; only between-group selection explains it (9/11).

- Four exhibits promised.

13. Ch. 9 — Exhibit A: Major Transitions

Keywords: boat race, prokaryotes, eukaryotes, superorganism, ultrasociality, motorboats

13.1 Major Transitions and the Insect Case — bacteria to bees

Keywords: mitochondria, Maynard Smith and Szathmáry, eight transitions, 2 percent by weight

- Boat race: solo → pair → tied seven → twenty-four sisters in a motorboat, passing everyone.
- Prokaryotes a billion years; ~2 bya two bacteria in one membrane (mitochondria keep DNA) → major transition; eukaryotes → limbs and organs.
- Maynard Smith/Szathmáry: eight transitions, last = human societies; free riding suppressed → superorganisms (organisms made of smaller organisms). Colonial insects: 2 percent of species, majority by weight.

13.2 The Human Case: Ultrasociality and the Three Factors — nest, children, conflict

Keywords: defensible nest, extended offspring care, intergroup conflict, city-states

- Ultrasociality = large groups with internal structure + division of labour; Hölldobler/Wilson: defensible nest, extended offspring care, intergroup conflict — all true of ancestors.
- Farming → granaries, walls, armies; world domination. → "They are motorboats."

14. Ch. 9 — Exhibit B: Shared Intentionality

Keywords: Rubicon, Tomasello, 68/74/35, moral matrix, group-mindedness, language

14.1 The Rubicon and the Experiments — the log and the tests

Keywords: two chimps and a log, physical tasks, social tasks, toddlers vs chimps

- Rubicon; Tomasello: "inconceivable… two chimpanzees carrying a log together."
- Experiments: physical tasks equal (68 percent); social tasks: toddlers 74 percent, chimps 35 percent.

14.2 Shared Intentionality, the Moral Matrix, and Two Steps — the Rubicon crossing

Keywords: colobus hunts, consensual hallucination, three to three thousand, portable nests

- shared intentionality: colobus "hunts" lack communication; sharing intentions scaled hunting, gathering, raiding; partners punished blockers and hoggers → first moral matrix ("our Rubicon crossing").

- Two steps: teams of 2–3 → group-mindedness 3→3,000 (norms, institutions, religion); language = "an agreement."
- → Human nests are weightless, portable moral communities.

15. Ch. 9 — Exhibit C: Genes and Cultures Coevolve

Keywords: cumulative culture, heidelbergensis, Richerson and Boyd, lactose, tribal instincts, self-domestication

15.1 The Timeline and Gene–Culture Coevolution — hominins and lactose

Keywords: Lucy, Oldowan, Acheulean, hearths and spears, lactase gene

- Timeline: 5–7 mya Lucy; ~2.4 mya habilis + Oldowan; ~1.8 mya Acheulean (unchanged a million years → innate like a beaver's dam); ~600–700 kya heidelbergensis — brains our size, hearths, spears, campsite, cooking.
- gene-culture coevolution (Richerson/Boyd): lactose mutation from dairying → cheese → more change.

15.2 Tribal Instincts and Self-Domestication — markers and tameness

Keywords: symbolic markers, shame and guilt, shunning, smaller teeth, neoteny

- tribal instincts: symbolic markers (tattoos, circumcision) forge "we" beyond kin; shame, guilt; the unruly shunned or killed → self-domestication (smaller teeth, less aggression, neoteny).
- → Overlay on selfish primate nature; dismissal of group selection premature.

16. Ch. 9 — Exhibit D: Evolution Can Be Fast

Keywords: Gould 2000, Belyaev's foxes, Muir's hens, genomic acceleration, calibrated claim, bottleneck

16.1 The Cases: Foxes and Hens — fast foxes, group hens

Keywords: tameness selection, thirty generations, group selection as breeding method, 67 to 8 percent, 91 to 237 eggs

- Gould (2000): "no biological change in humans in 40,000 or 50,000 years" — if true only the Pleistocene matters.
- *Example:* Belyaev's foxes — selected on tameness alone; domesticated by thirty generations ("docile, eager to please," Trut).
- *Example:* Muir's hens — individual selection: 67 percent deaths; group selection: 8 percent, eggs 91→237 by generation six.

16.2 Genomes, the Calibrated Claim, and the Bottleneck — crescendo and bottleneck

Keywords: Holocene crescendo, lactose and Tibetan genes, tweaking not new modules, Toba 74,000 years ago

- Genomes accelerated from ~40,000 ya; Holocene crescendo (lactose). Calibrated claim: no new modules in 12,000 years, but tweaks plausible if conditions held ~1,000 years. Toba (74,000 ya) bottleneck thought experiment; a short burst of group selection could yield our groupish adaptations.

17. Ch. 9 — "It's Not All About War": Newson's Correction

Keywords: competition without war, efficiency at turning resources into offspring, women and children

- Newson: "groups competing necessarily meant groups being at war" misleads — "competing to be the most efficient at turning resources into offspring. Don't forget that women and children were also very important members." Group selection needs no war; groupishness serves in-group welfare.

18. Ch. 9 — "In Sum": 90 Percent Chimp and 10 Percent Bee

Keywords: arc, hedged position, four exhibits, most but not all, hive switch

- Arc: Darwin believed in both levels; Williams and Dawkins banished group selection; three decades of individual competition; recent scholarship revives multiple levels. Haidt cannot prove group selection shaped us, but it best explains why we are simultaneously selfish and groupish.
- Four exhibits (memorise): A major transitions; B shared intentionality; C genes coevolve with cultures; D evolution can be fast.
- "Most, but not all" of human nature is individual-level: "90 percent chimp and 10 percent bee" — a hive switch flips when conditions are right (Ch. 10, outside this reading).

19. One-Page Revision Spine

Keywords: numbered recap, one line per section, exam revision

1. **Scope:** Ch. 7 (pp. 143–171) + Ch. 9 (pp. 206–238) only; foundations and left–right asymmetry, then group selection and the third principle.
2. **Homo economicus:** "selfishness or stupidity"; Figure 7.1's five pairs reveal moral foundations beyond self-interest.
3. **Innateness:** "organized in advance of experience"; Marcus's first draft; Moral Foundations Theory's two jobs.
4. **Care/harm:** vulnerable children; attachment; expandable triggers; Save Darfur vs wounded warrior.

5. **Fairness/cheating:** Trivers's reciprocal altruism; tit for tat; Occupy vs Tea Party; equality vs proportionality.
6. **Loyalty/betrayal:** Robbers Cave (1954); traitors hated more than enemies; Coulter's *Treason*.
7. **Authority/subversion:** hierarchy ≠ power; control role (de Waal); Hammurabi; Fiske's Authority Ranking.
8. **Sanctity/degradation:** Meiwes vs Mill's harm principle; ethic of divinity; omnivore's dilemma; Kass.
9. **Ch. 7 "In Sum":** five foundations one line each; left = Care + Fairness, right = all five.
10. **Ch. 9's puzzle:** 9/11 flag; Glauconian portrait plus groupish addendum; two options (individual-level vs group selection, banished 1970s).
11. **Darwin:** cohesive tribes win; free rider objection; multilevel selection; armies; 1966 halt.
12. **Banishment:** fast herd of deer; *Selfish Gene*; "me decade"; "giraffes of altruism."
13. **Exhibit A:** major transitions (eight); superorganisms; insects 2 percent of species; ultrasocial humans; "motorboats."
14. **Exhibit B:** Tomasello's log; 68/74/35 percent; shared intentionality → moral matrix; language last.
15. **Exhibit C:** hominin timeline; heidelbergensis; gene-culture coevolution; tribal instincts; self-domestication.
16. **Exhibit D:** Gould refuted; foxes; hens (67→8 percent, 91→237 eggs); calibrated claim; Toba.
17. **Qualification:** Newson — competition ≠ war; efficiency at turning resources into offspring.
18. **"In Sum":** Darwin banished then revived; four exhibits; "90 percent chimp and 10 percent bee."